

ENGLISH COMMUNICATION ASSESSMENT

Mid to Advanced Level | 30 Minutes per Section

Section	Time	Focus	Suggested Evaluation
1. Listening	30 minutes	Comprehension, inference, tone, detail	10 marks
2. Speaking	30 minutes	Fluency, pronunciation, structure, interaction	20 marks
3. Reading	30 minutes	Main idea, inference, vocabulary, critical reading	10 marks
4. Writing	30 minutes	Clarity, organization, grammar, professional tone	20 marks

Candidate Instructions

- Complete each section within 30 minutes. The evaluator may stop a section when time expires.
- For Listening, the evaluator should read the script twice at a natural pace. Candidates must not see the script before answering.
- For Speaking, select prompts according to the instructions and use the rubric provided.
- For Writing, follow the word limits and maintain a professional, coherent style.

Candidate Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Overall Notes:

SECTION 1 — LISTENING

Time: 30 minutes Marks: 10 Level: Mid to Advanced

The evaluator should read the passage twice. Read at a natural pace and do not pause after every sentence. Candidates may take brief notes.

Listening Script (for evaluator only)

Over the past decade, many organizations have invested heavily in hybrid work. Initially, the discussion focused on whether employees could remain productive outside the office. More recently, however, the debate has shifted toward how organizations can preserve collaboration, trust, and a shared sense of purpose when teams are distributed. Some managers respond by increasing meetings and monitoring activity, but this can create an illusion of control rather than genuine engagement. A more sustainable approach is to define outcomes clearly, document decisions, and create deliberate opportunities for informal interaction. Hybrid work also exposes inequalities: employees with quiet home offices may have an advantage over those sharing limited space or managing family responsibilities. Consequently, effective policies must be flexible without becoming vague, and consistent without pretending that every employee has identical circumstances. The strongest organizations treat hybrid work not as a fixed benefit but as an operating model that requires continuous review.

Candidate Questions

1. What was the original central question in the hybrid-work debate?

A. Whether employees could remain productive outside the office. B. Whether offices should be closed permanently. C. Whether salaries should be reduced. D. Whether technology was affordable.

2. According to the passage, what has the debate increasingly focused on?

A. Employee attendance records B. Collaboration, trust, and shared purpose C. Office decoration D. Reducing annual leave

3. Why may increasing meetings create an illusion of control?

A. Meetings are always unnecessary B. They may measure activity rather than meaningful engagement C. Employees dislike calendars D. Managers cannot use technology

4. Which action is presented as a more sustainable approach?

A. Monitoring every minute B. Avoiding written decisions C. Defining outcomes and documenting decisions D. Requiring identical schedules

5. What inequality does hybrid work expose?

A. Different levels of technical vocabulary B. Different access to quiet and suitable working environments C. Different commuting preferences only D. Different holiday calendars

6. The phrase 'flexible without becoming vague' implies that policies should be:

A. Unclear but popular B. Adaptable yet sufficiently defined C. Identical in every case D. Changed every day

7. What assumption does the passage reject?

A. All employees have identical circumstances B. Hybrid work needs review C. Trust matters D. Documentation is useful

8. What is the author's overall attitude toward hybrid work?

A. Entirely negative B. Uncritically enthusiastic C. Pragmatic and evaluative D. Indifferent

9. What does 'operating model' suggest in the final sentence?

A. A temporary experiment with no rules B. A structured way of organizing work C. A software application D. A financial product

10. Which statement best summarizes the passage?

A. Hybrid work succeeds through surveillance alone. B. Hybrid work is simple if meetings increase. C. Hybrid work requires thoughtful systems and ongoing adjustment. D. Hybrid work should replace all offices.

SECTION 2 — SPEAKING

Time: 30 minutes Marks: 20

The evaluator should assess the candidate using the rubric at the end of this section. The candidate must complete all three tasks.

Task 1: Structured Introduction — 5 minutes

Speak for 90–120 seconds on the topic: “**A professional skill I am currently developing and how I am measuring improvement.**” Include a clear opening, two specific examples, and a concluding statement.

Task 2: Opinion and Justification — 10 minutes

Choose **one** prompt. Speak for 2–3 minutes, then answer follow-up questions from the evaluator.

1. Should organizations prioritize employee flexibility or standardization? Explain the trade-offs.
2. Is artificial intelligence more likely to improve or weaken critical thinking in the workplace?
3. Should communication training be compulsory for technically strong employees?
4. Does remote communication require more discipline than face-to-face communication?
5. Is constructive disagreement a sign of a healthy team? Defend your position.

Task 3: Situational Role-play — 10 minutes

Respond naturally to the situation. The evaluator may interrupt with realistic follow-up questions.

1. You are leading a project that is behind schedule. One team member repeatedly misses deadlines but believes the workload is unfair. Address the issue without damaging the relationship.
2. A client says your team’s proposal is too complicated and asks for a simpler solution. Explain the value of the proposal while remaining open to revision.
3. You disagree with your manager’s decision during a meeting. Present your concern respectfully, support it with evidence, and suggest an alternative.
4. You must explain a technical problem to a non-technical stakeholder who is anxious about its impact. Make the explanation accurate, calm, and easy to understand.

Speaking Evaluation Rubric

Criteria	Excellent (4)	Competent (3)	Developing (2)	Limited (1)
Fluency & coherence	Smooth, well structured	Mostly fluent, minor pauses	Frequent pauses or repetition	Very difficult to sustain
Vocabulary	Precise, varied, contextual	Appropriate range	Basic or repetitive	Often inaccurate
Grammar	Accurate and flexible	Some errors, meaning clear	Repeated errors	Errors obstruct meaning
Pronunciation	Clear and natural	Generally clear	Occasional difficulty	Often difficult to understand
Interaction	Responsive, tactful, persuasive	Responds appropriately	Needs prompting	Limited engagement

Evaluator Comments: _____

SECTION 3 — READING

Time: 30 minutes Marks: 10

Read the passage and answer Questions 1–10.

In professional environments, clarity is often mistaken for simplicity. A message can be short and still be unclear if it leaves key assumptions unstated. Conversely, a detailed message can be highly efficient when its structure allows readers to locate the information they need. The real objective of effective communication is not to minimize words but to minimize avoidable interpretation. This requires the writer to anticipate the reader's questions, distinguish facts from judgments, and make the requested action explicit. It also requires restraint: adding every possible detail may protect the writer from being misunderstood, but it can burden the reader with irrelevant information. Strong communicators therefore make deliberate choices about emphasis. They know what must be stated, what can be implied, and what should be omitted. In this sense, clarity is less a matter of vocabulary than of judgment.

1. What is the central argument of the passage?

A. Shorter messages are always better. B. Clarity depends on judgment and structure, not just brevity. C. Detailed messages should be avoided. D. Readers should infer the action themselves.

2. The phrase 'avoidable interpretation' refers to:

A. Creative imagination B. Unnecessary uncertainty about meaning C. Translation errors only D. A reader's personal opinion

3. Why can a detailed message be efficient?

A. It contains every possible fact B. Its structure helps readers find needed information C. It avoids making requests D. It uses complex vocabulary

4. Which of the following should a writer distinguish?

A. Facts from judgments B. Readers from writers C. Short sentences from long sentences D. Emails from reports

5. What does the author mean by 'make the requested action explicit'?

A. Use more adjectives B. Clearly state what the reader should do C. Avoid deadlines D. Ask the reader to guess

6. Why can too much detail be harmful?

A. It is always inaccurate B. It may burden the reader with irrelevant information C. It makes the message shorter D. It prevents any interpretation

7. The word 'restraint' most nearly means:

A. Careful limitation B. Aggressive persuasion C. Complete silence D. Rapid delivery

8. What does the passage suggest about vocabulary?

A. Advanced words guarantee clarity B. Vocabulary is irrelevant in all cases C. Judgment is more important than vocabulary alone D. Simple words should never be used

9. Which statement is consistent with the passage?

A. Every detail should be included. B. A well-organized long message can be clearer than a short one. C. Readers should supply missing actions. D. Facts and judgments should be mixed.

10. Which title best fits the passage?

A. Why Short Emails Always Win B. The Hidden Cost of Vocabulary C. Clarity as a Matter of Judgment D. How to Avoid Professional Communication

SECTION 4 — WRITING

Time: 30 minutes Marks: 20

Complete all three tasks. Use a professional tone, logical organization, accurate grammar, and specific language.

Task 1: Professional Email — 7 marks

Write an email of 120–150 words to a project manager explaining that a deliverable will be delayed by two working days. Give a credible reason, explain the impact, propose a recovery plan, and request any support you need.

Task 2: Analytical Paragraph — 6 marks

Write 150–180 words on: **“Effective communication is a responsibility shared by the sender and the receiver.”** Present a clear position and support it with examples.

Task 3: Editing and Rewriting — 7 marks

Rewrite the following message so that it is grammatically correct, concise, tactful, and suitable for a professional email:

“You did not send the files on time again and because of this the whole team is suffering. Please understand that everyone has their own work and it is not possible for us to keep waiting for you. Send it immediately and don’t repeat this mistake.”

Writing Evaluation Rubric

Criteria	Marks	What is expected
Task fulfillment	5	All instructions addressed; appropriate detail and tone
Organization	5	Clear opening, logical progression, effective conclusion
Grammar & sentence control	4	Accurate structures and varied sentences
Vocabulary & register	3	Precise, professional, context-appropriate language
Mechanics	3	Spelling, punctuation, formatting

Evaluator Comments:

ANSWER KEY & EVALUATOR GUIDE

Listening

1-A 2-B 3-B 4-C 5-B 6-B 7-A 8-C 9-B 10-C

Reading

1-B 2-B 3-B 4-A 5-B 6-B 7-A 8-C 9-B 10-C

Speaking

Use the five-category rubric. Maximum rubric score is 20. Record brief evidence for fluency, vocabulary, grammar, pronunciation, and interaction.

Writing

Use the writing rubric for a maximum of 20 marks. Give particular attention to task completion, professional tone, logical organization, and grammatical accuracy.

Suggested Overall Interpretation

Score	Interpretation
80–100%	Advanced readiness — communicates accurately, flexibly, and independently.
65–79%	Strong intermediate to upper-intermediate — generally effective with some areas to refine.
50–64%	Developing — can communicate meaning but needs targeted improvement.
Below 50%	Needs structured practice in comprehension, fluency, accuracy, and organization.